

25. Given below are two statements, one is labelled Assertion (A), and other is labelled as Reason (R).
Assertion (A) : Babur wrote his memoirs in Turki.
Reason (R) : Turki was the official language of the Mughal Court.

In the context of the above two statements, which one of the following is correct?

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not a correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

I.A.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (c)

The founder of the Mughal Empire, Zahiruddin Muhammad Babur wrote his memoirs (autobiography) 'Tuzuk-i-Babri' also known as Baburnama written in Turkish language containing related events of his life. The Turkish language was not the official language of the Mughal Empire. The Persian language was the official language of Mughal empire. Thus, Assertion (A) is correct, but Reason (R) is incorrect.

26. In which language was Tuzuk-i-Baburi' written?

- (a) Persian
- (b) Arabic
- (c) Turkish
- (d) Urdu

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

27. Who built the Babri mosque established in Ayodhya?

- (a) Babur
- (b) Humayun
- (c) Nizam-ul-Mulk
- (d) Mir Baqi

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (d)

It is believed that Babri mosque in Ayodhya was built by Mir Baqi. He was the commandant of Babur.

Humayun and Sher Shah

***Kamran, Askari, and Hindal** were the sons of Babur and the brothers of **Humayun**. Humayun was the eldest son of Babur, born in Kabul in 1508 AD. His mother, **Maham Begum** was related to the Shia sect. **Gulrukh Begum** was the mother of Kamran and Askari whereas **Dildar Begam** was the mother of Hindal.

*Humayun invaded **Chunar Fort** for the first time in 1532. Humayun besieged this fort for four months and, after that, Sher

Khan accepted his supremacy. In addition to this, he invaded **Kalinjar** in 1531 AD and annexed **Raisina** Fort in 1532 AD.

*The four significant major battles fought by Humayun are as follows- **Devara, Chausa, Kannauj** and **Sirhind**. Humayun defeated Afghan rebels on the banks of **Gomti** at **Daurah** (Devara) in 1532 AD. *Humayun was defeated by Sher Shah in **Battle of Chausa** on **26 June 1539 AD**, in which a water fetcher named Nizam saved his life. This victory against Humayun increased the prestige and power of Sher Shah (Sher Khan).

*On **17 May 1540 AD** Humayun was defeated by Sher Shah again in the **Battle of Kannauj** (Bilgram) and Humayun fled from one place to the other after this war.

*Humayun occupied Delhi again in the **Battle of Sirhind** on **22 June, 1555 AD**.

***Farid Khan** who later became Sher Shah Suri, got his education from Jaunpur. He left his home in 1494 A.D. and came to Jaunpur for studies which was famous as "Siraj-i-Hind" during that time. *Haji Begum had constructed her husband Humayun's Tomb at Delhi (Deen Panah) in **1565-1572 A.D.** It is the first double dome mausoleum of Mughal Architecture. Mirak Mirza Ghiyas was the architect of this tomb.

*Sher Shah Suri had a significant role in Revenue reforms, Administrative reforms, Military Reforms and Currency system reforms. He introduced a different system for Bengal province. He divided the Bengal province into Sirkars (districts) and appointed a military official as **Shiqdar** to control. *A non-military official **Amir-i-Bengal** or 'Amin-i-Bengal' was also appointed for assistance. **Qazi Fajilat** was the first man to be appointed to this post. *Sher Shah introduced pure gold, silver and copper coins. His silver 'Rupree' coins weighed 178 grains, and copper's 'Daam' weighed 380 grains. The exchange rate of Rupee and Daam was 1 : 64. *Sher Shah died on **22 May 1545 AD** in Kalinjar. Kalinjar campaign was the last campaign of Sher Shah. Kirat Singh was the king of the Kalinjar at that time. Sher Shah Suri was extremely impressed by chivalry and courage of Rajputs during the battle of Marwar and said, "I would have lost the empire just for a handful of millet". *The tomb of Sher Shah is in the middle of a tank. *This tomb is located at Sasaram in Bihar. *"**Purana Quila**" was constructed by Sher Shah and Humayun in Delhi. Here, **Qila-i-Kuhna** mosque was built by Sher Shah.

*Sher Shah introduced the system of "**Patta**" and "**Qabuliyat**" to help the peasants. The peasants were given "patta" by the central authority, in which the share of government was clearly mentioned. The peasants accepted it through "Qabuliyat".

1. From the following names identify the one who was not the brother of Humayun.

- (a) Kamran
- (b) Usman
- (c) Askari
- (d) Hindal

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

Kamran, Askari, and Hindal were the sons of Babur and the brothers of Humayun. Humayun was the eldest son of Babur, born in Kabul in 1508 A.D. His mother, Maham Begum was related to Shia sect. Usman was not his brother.

2. Arrange properly as per dates of four important battles fought by Humayun, the names of battlefields are given below –

- (a) Chausa, Devara, Kanauj, Sirhind
- (b) Devara, Kanauj, Chausa, Sirhind
- (c) Sirhind, Devara, Chausa, Kanauj
- (d) Devara, Chausa, Kanauj, Sirhind

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

The correct order of battles fought by Humayun is as follows- Devara, Chausa, Kannauj and Sirhind. Humayun defeated Afghan rebels on the banks of Gomati at Devara or Daurah in 1532 A.D. Sher Shah defeated Humayun in the Battle of Chausa on 26 June 1539 AD in which a water fetcher named Nizam saved his life. This victory against Humayun increased the prestige and power of Sher Shah. He read 'Khutba' by his name, occupying the title of Sher Shah and engraved this on the coins.

On 17th May, 1540 AD Humayun was again defeated by Sher Shah in the Battle of Kanauj (Bilgram) and Humayun fled from one place to the other after this war. Humayun occupied Delhi again in the Battle of Sirhind on 22th June, 1555 AD.

3. According to 'Rao-Jaitsi-Ro-Chhanda', who among the following was defeated by Rao Jaitsi, the ruler of Bikaner?

- (a) Humayun
- (b) Kamran
- (c) Shershah
- (d) Akbar
- (e) Question not attempted

Rajasthan P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

After the death of Mughal Emperor Babur, his son Humayun ascended the Mughal throne. After coming to power, Humayun wanted to establish firm control over northern India by subduing the Rajput states. To achieve this, he sent his brother Kamran Mirza against Rao Jaitsi (or Rao Jait Singh), the independent ruler of Bikaner, in the 1530s. According to Beethu Souza's text Rao-Jaitsi-Ro-Chhanda, a battle took place between Kamran and Rao Jaitsi, in which Rao Jaitsi defeated Kamran.

4. Who among the following made an offer to Humayun that he would surrender Bihar and pay an annual tribute of 10 lakh dinars if he was allowed to retain Bengal?

- (a) Bahadur Shah
- (b) Sher Khan
- (c) Bairam Khan
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Sher Khan made an offer to Mughal emperor Humayun that he would surrender Bihar and Pay an annual tribute of 10 lakh dinars if he was allowed to retain Bengal, but Humayun declined the offer.

5. Which of the following two rulers fought the battle near Kannauj of 17th May 1540?

- (a) Humayun and Sultan Mohammad Nuhani
- (b) Shershah and Humayun
- (c) Shershah and Mirza Kamran
- (d) Mohammad Shah and Humayun

U.P.B.E.O. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

Shershah Suri & Humayun fought the battle near Kannauj on 17th May 1540 AD. Shershah defeated Humayun. Since the battle was fought in an ancient town, Bilgram (now municipal board in Hardoi district, U.P.), it is also called Battle of Bilgram.

6. From where did Fareed, who later on became Sher Shah Suri, get his education :

- (a) Sasaram
- (b) Patna
- (c) Jaunpur
- (d) Lahore

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

Farid Khan, who later became Sher Shah Suri, got his education from Jaunpur. He left his home in 1494 AD and came to Jaunpur for studies which was famous as "Siraj-i-Hind" during that time.

7. Which one of the following medieval era rulers mentioned below was highly educated?

- (a) Balban
- (b) Alauddin Khalji
- (c) Ibrahim Lodi
- (d) Sher Shah

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (d)

Sher Shah completed his formal education in Jaunpur, which was the center of education at that time.

8. Which of the following rulers at first assumed the title of 'Hazrat-e-Ala' and afterwards 'Sultan'?

- (a) Bahlul Lodi
- (b) Sikandar Lodi
- (c) Sher Shah Suri
- (d) Islam Shah Suri

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (c)

Sher Khan assumed the title of 'Hazrat-e-Ala' after defeating the ruler of Bengal, Nusrat Shah. He assumed the royal title of 'Sher Shah' after defeating Humayun in the Battle of Chausa on June 26th, 1539 AD and ordered to read Khutba by his name and the coins to be minted his name.

9. Which improvements among these were done by Sher Shah Suri?

- (1) Revenue reforms
- (2) Administrative reforms
- (3) Military reforms
- (4) Currency system reforms

Select the right answer by using code given below –

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 1,2 and 3
- (c) 2,3 and 4
- (d) all the above

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

Sher Shah Suri had a significant role in medieval India. He is considered the antecedent of Akbar as an administrative imperialist.

(1) **Revenue reforms:** Sher Shah believed that for the stability of the empire, it was essential to satisfy the peasants and make them happy. He introduced numerous reforms in land revenue administration. His land revenue collection was based on Rayatwari and was settled directly with cultivators. He adopted an improved and systematic method of measuring the land and assessing its revenue.

(2) **Administrative Reforms:** Sher Shah managed his father's manor as manager and obtained the essential knowledge of administration. He had a proper knowledge of military composition, administration and financial system of Mughals. He was the head of the central government. His administration was completely centralised before victory over Bengal. He divided the whole kingdom into 47 Sirkars (districts) (According to Dr. Kanungo).

He arranged a different system for Bengal province. He divided the province into 19 Sirkars (districts) (According to Satish Chandra) and appointed a military official as Shiqdar to control.

A non-military official Amir-i-Bengal was also appointed for assistance. This arrangement was made for the abolishment of revolt threat.

(3) **Military Reforms:** Sher Shah introduced many reforms in military sector for empire consolidation. He was inspired by reforms of Alauddin Khalji. He recruited and paid the soldiers directly and every soldier had his chehra (face) recorded and his horse branded with an imperial sign, to stop fraud.

(4) **Currency System Reforms:** The reign of Sher Shah was an era of experiment in the history of coins. V.A. Smith rightly observes "It is the basis of the existing British currency". He introduced pure gold, silver and copper coins in place of the beaten coins. His silver rupee coins weighed 178 grains and coppers Daam weighed 380 grains. Thus, credit of these reforms goes to Sher Shah Suri.

10. After the downfall of the Delhi Sultanate, who was the first ruler to issue the gold coin?

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Humayun
- (c) Shah Jahan
- (d) Sher Shah

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (b)

After the downfall of Delhi Sultanate, Humayun was the first ruler to issue a gold coin. It is also mentioned that after Humayun, Sher Shah also introduced a gold coin. UKPSC accepted option (a) as the right answer, which is wrong.

11. When Humayun invaded Chunar Fort first time?

- (a) 1532
- (b) 1531
- (c) 1533
- (d) 1536

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

Humayun invaded Chunar Fort for the first time in 1532 AD. Humayun besieged this fort for four months, and after that, Sher Khan accepted his supremacy. In addition to this, he invaded Kalinjar in 1531 AD and annexed Raisina fort in 1532 AD.

12. Consider the following events and arrange them in chronological order

- I. Battle of Daurah
- II. Battle of Kanauj
- III. Battle of Samugarh
- IV. Battle of Chausa

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) II, III, I, IV
- (b) I, IV, II, III
- (c) I, II, IV, III
- (d) II, I, IV, III

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (b)

The correct chronological order of the above-mentioned events is - Battle of Daurah (1532 A.D.), Battle of Chausa (1539 A.D.), Battle of Kanauj (1540 A.D.) and Battle of Samugarh (1658 A.D.). Humayun defeated Mahmud Lodi in battle of Daurah. Sher Shah defeated Humayun in the Battle of Kanauj. The Battle of Samugarh was fought between Dara Shikoh and his two younger brothers, Aurangzeb and Murad Baksh. Battle of Chausa was fought between Sher Shah and Humayun.

13. Who among the following has constructed a mausoleum for her emperor husband?

- (a) Shah Begum (b) Haji Begum
(c) Mumtaz Mahal Begum (d) Nurnissa Begum

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

Haji Begum constructed a mausoleum for her husband Humayun at Delhi in 1565-1572 A.D. as 'tomb of Humayun.' Mirak Mirza Ghiyash, a Persian, was the architect employed by Haji Begum for this tomb. It is the first double dome mausoleum of Mughal Architecture A garden, surrounds outwards of the tomb.

14. Who introduced coin of silver?

- (a) Akbar (b) Sher Shah
(c) Alauddin Khalji (d) Bakhtiyar Khalji

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (b)

Sher Shah is honoured for the establishment of the reformed currency system, which circulated during the Mughal period and became the basis of British currency. He introduced pure gold, silver and copper coins as well as abolished currency coins of mixed metal, which had fixed-rate and sizes. His silver rupee coins weighed 178 grains of which 173 grains were pure silver. Sher Shah's name, title and place of mint were invariably inscribed on the coins in Arabic language and Devanagari script.

15. What was the exchange rate of silver's rupiya ?

- (a) 16:1 (b) 32:1
(c) 48:1 (d) 64:1

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (d)

The currency system of Sher Shah was well-developed. He introduced pure silver's Rupiya (Rupee) (178 grains) and Copper Daam (380 grains). At that time the exchange rate of Rupiya and Daam was 1 : 64.

16. The pure silver "rupiya" was issued by

- (a) Akbar (b) Sher Shah
(c) Jahangir (d) Aurangzeb

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

17. With reference to Sher Shah Suri, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. He was the architect of a brilliant administrative system.
2. However his qualities as a ruler were not more remarkable than his victories on the field of battle.

Select the correct answer from the code given below :

Code :

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2021

Ans. (a)

A brave warrior and a successful conqueror, Sher Shah was the architect of a brilliant administrative system. In fact, his qualities as a ruler were more remarkable than his victories on the battlefields. His brief reign of five years was marked by the introduction of wise and salutary changes in every conceivable branch of administration. Hence, the first statement is true, while the second statement is false.

18. Death of Sher Shah Suri occurred in :-

- (a) Agra (b) Kalinjar
(c) Rohtas (d) Sasaram

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (b)

Sher Shah Suri died on May 22, 1545 AD, during the siege of the Kalinjar Fort of Rajputs. When all the tactics to subdue this fort failed, he ordered the walls of the fort to be blown up with gunpowder. He was seriously wounded by the explosion. The Kalinjar was last campaign of Shershah.

19. Last expedition of Sher Shah Suri was against which of the following States?

- (a) Kalanjar (b) Malwa
(c) Kannauj (d) Gaur

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

20. With which medieval ruler would you associate the statement 'I would have lost the empire just for a handful of millet' ?

- (a) Alauddin Khalji (b) Muhammad Tughluq
(c) Sher Shah (d) Aurangzeb

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (c)

Sher Shah Suri was extremely impressed by chivalry and courage of Rajputs during the battle of Marwar that he expressed his feelings in the above statement.

21. From which place were Jayata and Kumpa associated who impressed Shershah with their valour?

- (a) Malwa (b) Mewar
(c) Bundelkhand (d) Marwar

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (d)

In the Battle of Sammel with Sher Shah Suri, Maldeo Rathore lost. His Army Generals, Jaita and Kumpa, gave a tough fight with just a few thousand men against the larger army of Sher Shah. Due to the valour and courage of Jaita and Kumpa, Sher Shah Suri's army suffered heavy losses. Sher Shah is said to have commented that "for a few grains of bajra (Millets), I almost lost the entire kingdom of Hindustan".

22. Where is Mausoleum of Sher Shah ?

- (a) Sasaram (b) Delhi
(c) Kalinjar (d) Sonargaon

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016
U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (a)

The tomb of Sher Shah is an imposing brick structure partly veneered with stone standing in the middle of a tank. This tomb is located at Sasaram of Rohtas in Bihar. It is regarded as one of the noblest specimens of Afghan architecture in India.

23. Where is Sher Shah's tomb located?

- (a) Sasaram (b) Maner
(c) Sitamarhi (d) Pavapuri
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

24. Sher Shah was buried at –

- (a) Kalinjar (b) Sasaram
(c) Jaunpur (d) Patna

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (b)

Sher Shah was the son of an Afghan Jagirdar from Sasaram, Bihar. He was originally named Farid Khan but was given the title of 'Sher' after he killed a tiger. He died in 1545 A.D. and was buried at Sasaram.

25. Which one of the following is a monument constructed by Sher Shah?

- (a) Qila-i-Kuhna at Delhi
(b) Atala Masjid at Jaunpur
(c) Bara Sona Masjid at Gaur
(d) Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque in Delhi

I.A.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (a)

The short reign of Sher Shah is a revolutionary era in the history of Indian architecture. Qila-i-Kuhna, built in 1541 A.D., is famous for its elegant architectural qualities in historical monuments of northern India.

26. Building of "Purana Qila" was constructed in Delhi by–

- (a) Firuz Tughluq (b) Ibrahim Lodi

(c) Sher Shah

(d) Babur

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (c)

"Purana Qila" was constructed by Sher Shah & Humayun in Delhi. Here, Qila-i-Kuhna mosque and Sher Mandal monuments were built by Sher Shah.

27. Who built the mosque "Qila-E-Kuhna" inside Purana Qila of Delhi

- (a) Humayun (b) Sher Shah
(c) Akbar (d) Shah Jahan

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2021

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

28. Who amongst the following got 'Purana Quila' of Delhi built in the present form?

- (a) Sher Shah Suri (b) Akbar
(c) Babur (d) Shah Jahan

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (a)

Purana Quila is one of the oldest forts in Delhi. Its current form was built by Sher Shah Suri, the founder of the Sur Empire. Humayun raised the citadel of Purana Qila, which had an extensive area sprawling around it.

29. Which of the following monuments were built by Emperor Shershah?

1. Sasaram Tomb
2. Qila-e-Kuhna Mosque
3. Tomb of Sikandar
4. Jama Masjid

- (a) 1, 2 (b) 1, 3
(c) 1, 4 (d) 2, 4
(e) Question not attempted

Rajasthan P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

The tomb of Sasaram, also known as the tomb of Sher Shah Suri, is located in the Rohtas district of present-day Bihar. The construction of this tomb, built with an octagonal architectural plan, was started during the Shershah's reign (1540–45 AD), but it was completed on August 16, 1545 AD, during the reign of his son, Islam Shah. In Delhi, the Qila-e-Kuhna Mosque, located inside Purana Qila (Old Fort), was built by Shershah Suri in 1541 AD. The tomb of Akbar, located in Sikandra (Agra, Uttar Pradesh), was initiated during Akbar's reign but was completed in 1612 AD during the rule of Jahangir. The Jama Masjid in Delhi was constructed under the patronage of Shah Jahan. Thus, only the Tomb of Sasaram and the Qila-e-Kuhna Mosque were built by Sher Shah Suri.